



Manage Your E-books Using Calibre

Kovid Goyal's 'Calibre E-Book Management' is a seamless cross-platform library-management tool for e-books of almost any format under the sun. Its features boggle the mind. Bibliomania doesn't get better than this! Read on as I walk you through this cool utility.

We all hoard data in one way or another. Some of us have loads of music and some of us have loads of movies. It all began when personal computing became affordable and all of us got to play with these virtual packets of data called files. Then came the Internet and the Napster era—MP3 files flowed in the thousands. That called for some serious media file management—what we now so effortlessly do (most of the time) using Rhythmbox or iTunes (if you're an Apple fan). HTPC (Home Theatre Personal Computer) Operating Systems like MoviX or their software suite counterparts like XBMC (the Xbox Media Center) allow management of not just music, but your videos, TV shows and online radio too. As data grows, it is only its swift management that keeps us from going mad and pulling our hair out, as those ones and zeroes flow in torrential fury.

Just when we thought the worst was behind us, good ol' Murphy paid us another visit... and lo and behold, e-books arrived. Add to it the cool convenience of e-book readers like the Kindle and the Nook, and you find yourself hoarding e-books too! The question now arises: is there a (FOSS) way to manage all my e-books? The answer is, "Yes, there is." Calibre is really neat. A cross-platform tool (yes, it does Windows, Linux and Mac), it lets you manage e-books of almost any format under the sun. It syncs up with almost all the popular e-book readers out there—and the cherry on the cake is that it can double up as a content-management server,

allowing you to share your collection on your local network via a Web interface!

Installing Calibre

Let's get started. Installation is pretty straightforward. If you are a Windows or a Mac user, it is a simple download-double-click-install process. If you're a Linux user, there are two ways (both listed on the download page link at the end of the article). These are:

- Use the package provided by your distribution—not recommended, since it may not be updated regularly.
- Manually perform a binary installation using the following command:

```
sudo python -c "import urllib2;
exec urllib2.urlopen('http://status.calibre-ebook.
com/linux_installer').read(); main()"
```

Using Calibre as a management tool

Start Calibre from the Main Menu or by typing 'calibre' in the Run Command dialogue box or even in the terminal. You will be greeted with a first-start wizard, which asks you questions like which e-book reader you are using (if any) and where you want the library to reside. Completing the wizard brings up the main window (Figure 1).

The Calibre main window consists of: